

NBA Three Point Revolution

Season: 2025-26

L1 • The league curve

In 2000-01, about one shot in six came from beyond the arc. By 2025-26 it was more than two in five. This section measures how big that change was, how fast it happened, and when it took off.

The headline. In 2000-01, 17% of all shots were threes. In 2025-26 it was 41.5%, 2.4 times as many. The rest of this dashboard explains how the league got from the first number to the second.

3PA share in 2000-01 (%)

17%

3PA share in 2025-26 (%)

41.5%

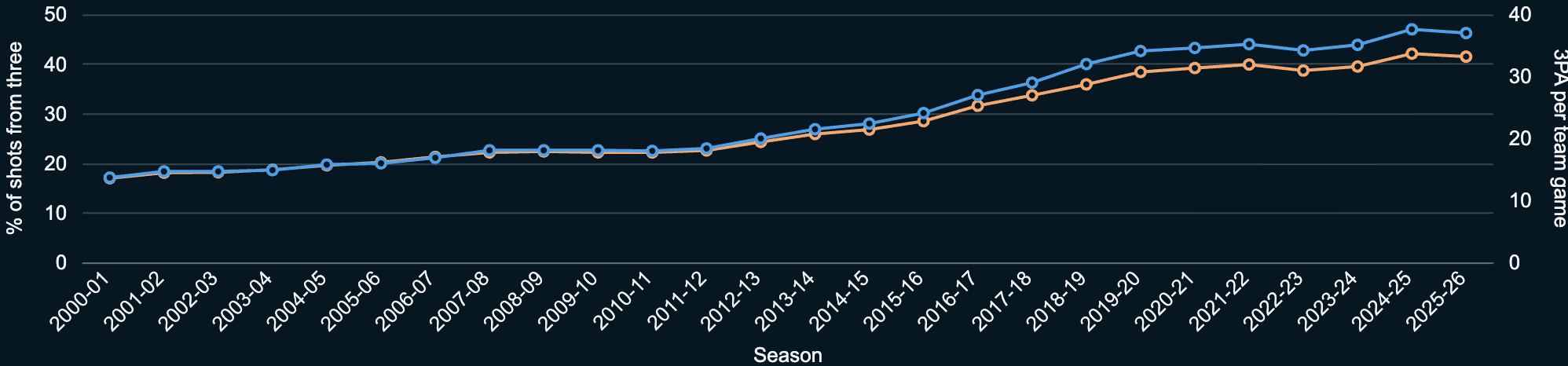
How many times larger

2.4x

A slow drift, then a surge. The share of shots taken from three crept from 17% to 22% by 2008-09, then stalled for three seasons. From 2012-13 it rose every year, reaching 38.4% in 2019-20, and has stayed around 40% since. The second line (right axis) is threes attempted per team per game.

Share of shots taken from three, by season

% of shots from three 3PA per team game

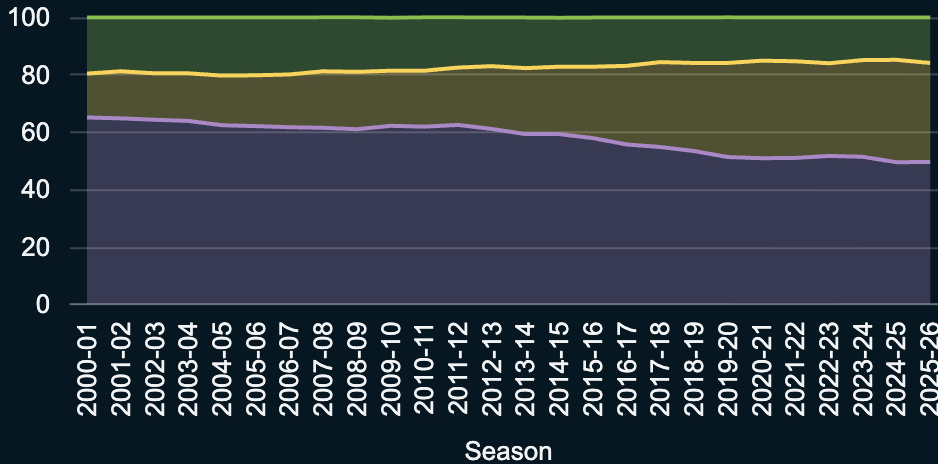


Where the points come from. Threes went from 15% of all points scored to about 35%, while twos fell from 65% to under 50%. 2024-25 was the first season in which less than half of the league's points came from two-point baskets.

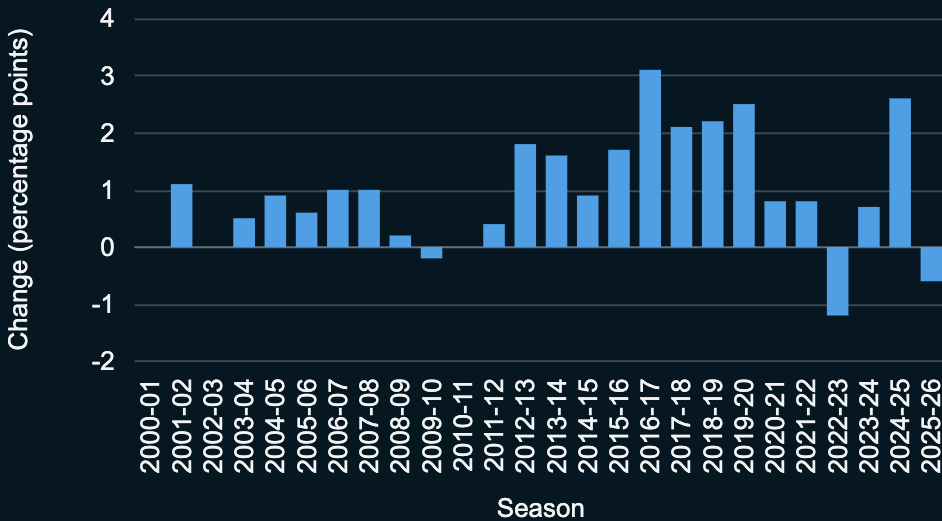
Finding the inflection point. Each bar is how much the three-point share rose over the season before. Through 2011-12 the bars are small or flat. The big jumps cluster from 2012-13 to 2019-20, peaking at +3.1 percentage points in 2016-17. That stretch is the revolution itself.

Where the points come from (% of points)

pct_points_from_free_throws pct_points_from_threes pct_points_from_twos



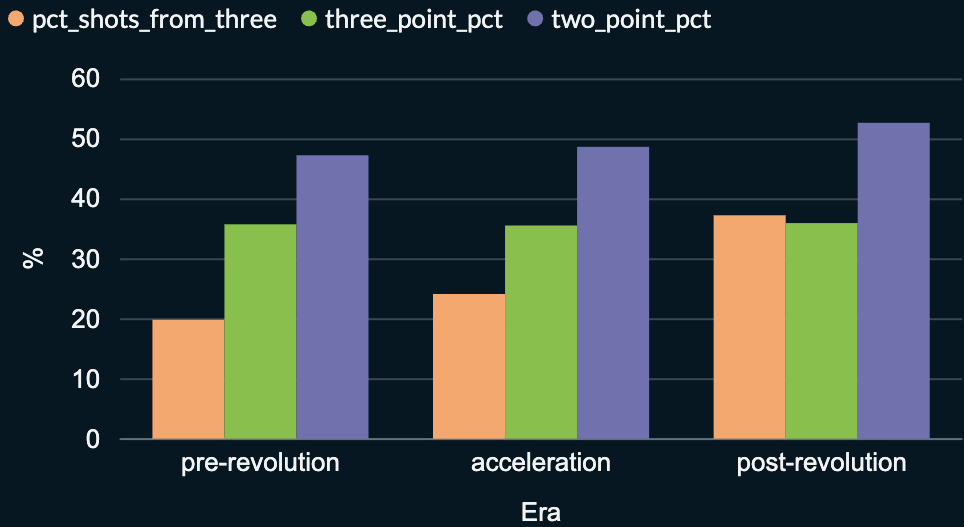
Inflection point: season-over-season change in 3PA share



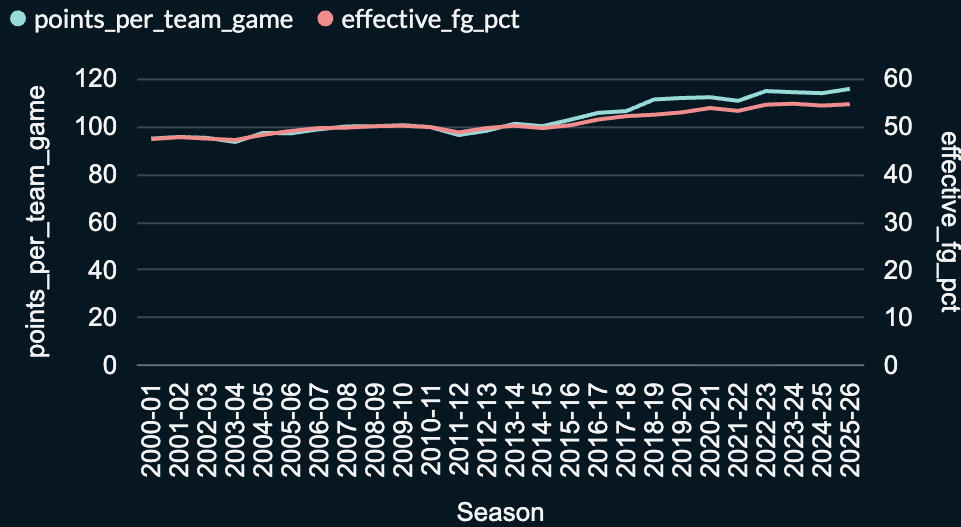
More threes, not better shooters. Between the first and last eras, the share of shots from three nearly doubled (19.8% to 37.2%), but three-point accuracy barely moved (35.7% to 35.9%). Two-point accuracy rose (47.2% to 52.6%), which fits teams giving up long, low-percentage twos.

Offense got better, too. Points per team per game rose from 94.8 to 115.6. Effective field-goal percentage, which counts a made three as 1.5 made shots, rose from 47.3% to 54.6%. The game didn't just change shape; scoring became more efficient alongside the shift.

Volume exploded, accuracy flat: 3PA share vs shooting % by era



Points per game and effective FG% by season

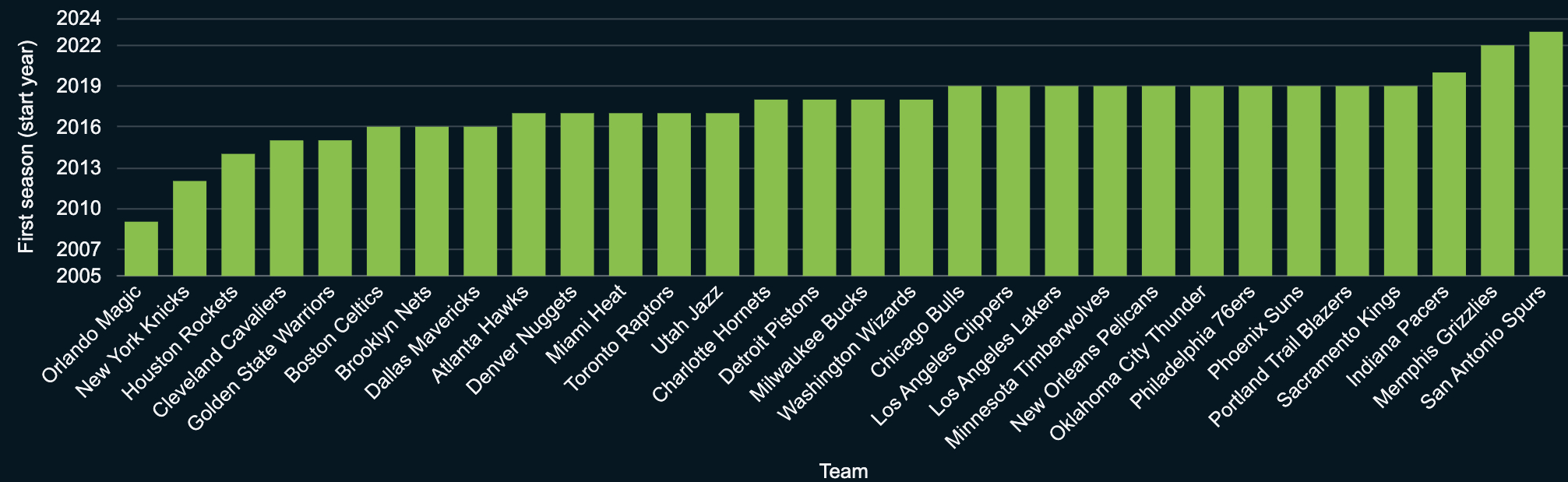


L2 • Who moved first

A league average hides the teams that moved before everyone else. This section ranks every franchise against the league, season by season, to find the early movers.

Adoption year. The first season each franchise took at least 35% of its shots from three. Orlando got there first (2009-10), then New York (2012-13) and Houston (2014-15). 19 of the 30 franchises crossed the line between 2017-18 and 2019-20. San Antonio was last, in 2023-24.

Adoption year: first season at 35%+ of shots from three



Leaders during the acceleration era (2009-10 to 2014-15). Houston and New York ranked in the league's top five for three-point share in five of those six seasons. Atlanta, Orlando and Phoenix did it three times. The chart shows only franchises with at least two top-five seasons.

The league leader, season by season. Boston led early (33.1% in 2002-03), Phoenix in the mid-2000s, and Orlando from 2007-08 to 2011-12. Houston took over in 2013-14, led seven straight seasons and passed 50% in 2017-18. Use the **Season** filter at the top to pick one season.

Acceleration-era leaders: seasons in the top five by 3PA share

Team	Seasons in top 5
Houston Rockets	5
New York Knicks	5
Atlanta Hawks	3
Orlando Magic	3
Phoenix Suns	3
Brooklyn Nets	2
Dallas Mavericks	2
Los Angeles Clippers	2

Top three 3PA-share teams each season

season	season_rank	team_name	pct_shots_from_three
2025-26	1	Golden State Warriors	49.7
2025-26	2	Charlotte Hornets	48.7
2025-26	3	Portland Trail Blazers	46.9
3 rows			

The ten biggest three-point outliers in a season. For the season picked in the **Season** filter, the ten teams that took the most of their shots from three relative to that season's league average (in percentage points). With no season picked, it shows 2000-01. The biggest outlier in all 26 seasons is 2017-18 Houston, 16.5 points above the league. (Team names are current: 2003-04 "Oklahoma City" is the Seattle SuperSonics.)

Top 10 teams vs the league-average 3PA share, by season			
season	team_name	pct_shots_from_three	vs_league_pct_points
2025-26	Golden State Warriors	49.7	8.2
2025-26	Charlotte Hornets	48.7	7.2
2025-26	Portland Trail Blazers	46.9	5.3
2025-26	Boston Celtics	46.7	5.2
2025-26	Milwaukee Bucks	45.7	4.2
2025-26	Brooklyn Nets	45.5	4
2025-26	Phoenix Suns	45.3	3.8
2025-26	Chicago Bulls	44.3	2.8
2025-26	Cleveland Cavaliers	44.2	2.7
2025-26	Memphis Grizzlies	43.6	2.1
10 rows			

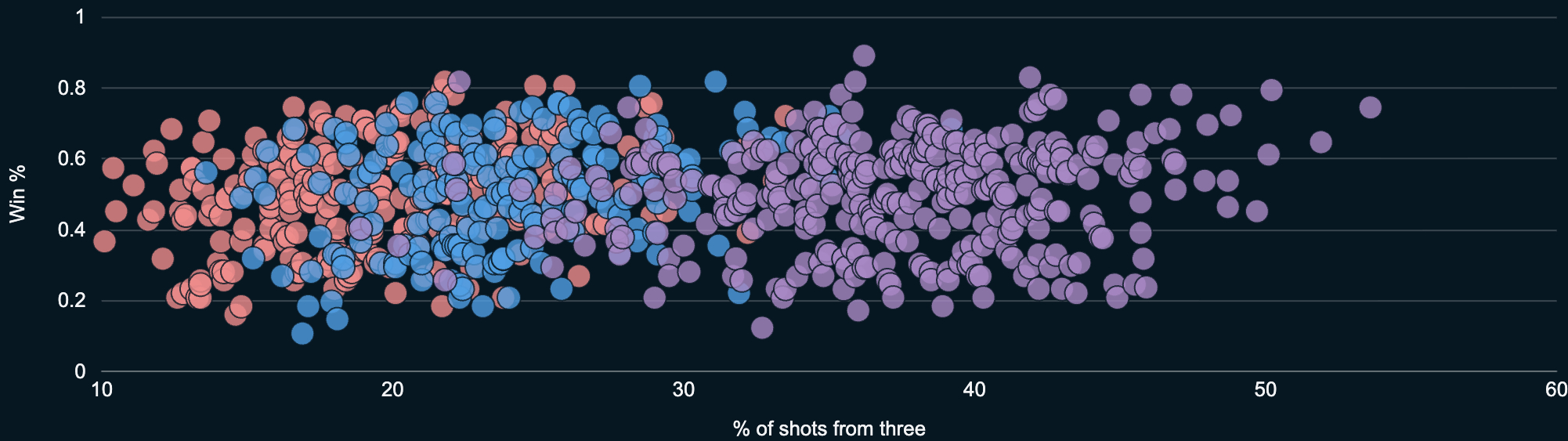
L3 • Did it work?

Shooting more threes changed how the game looks. Did it change who wins? This section compares each team's three-point profile with its record, in the same season and in the seasons that followed.

All 776 team-seasons. Each dot is one team in one season, colored by era. The whole cloud slides right over time: teams took 10–34% of their shots from three before 2009-10, and 19–54% from 2015-16 on. But in every era, win percentage covers the full range. Volume alone doesn't decide who wins.

Every team-season: 3PA share vs win %

● pre-revolution ● acceleration ● post-revolution

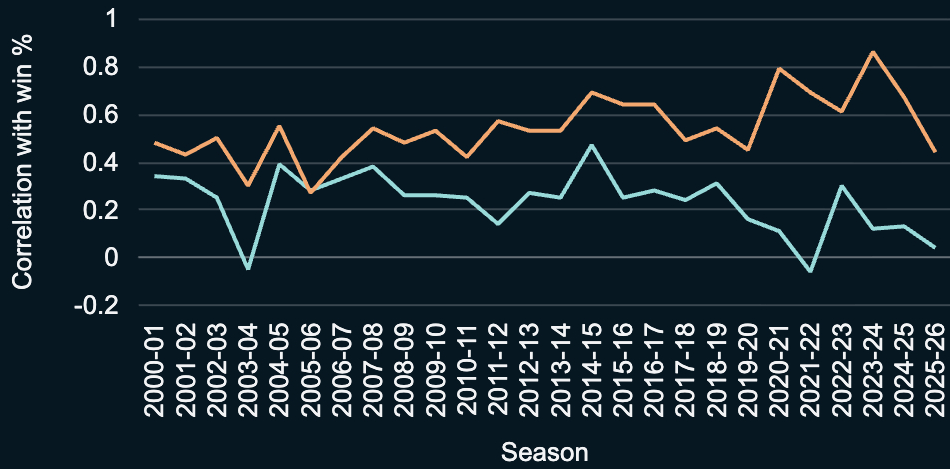


Accuracy matters more than volume. How closely win % tracks three-point attempts per game vs three-point percentage, each season (1 = in step, 0 = no link). Accuracy is the stronger link in all but one season, usually 0.4 to 0.8. Since 2019-20, volume's link has mostly stayed below 0.15: when everyone shoots threes, shooting more stops setting teams apart.

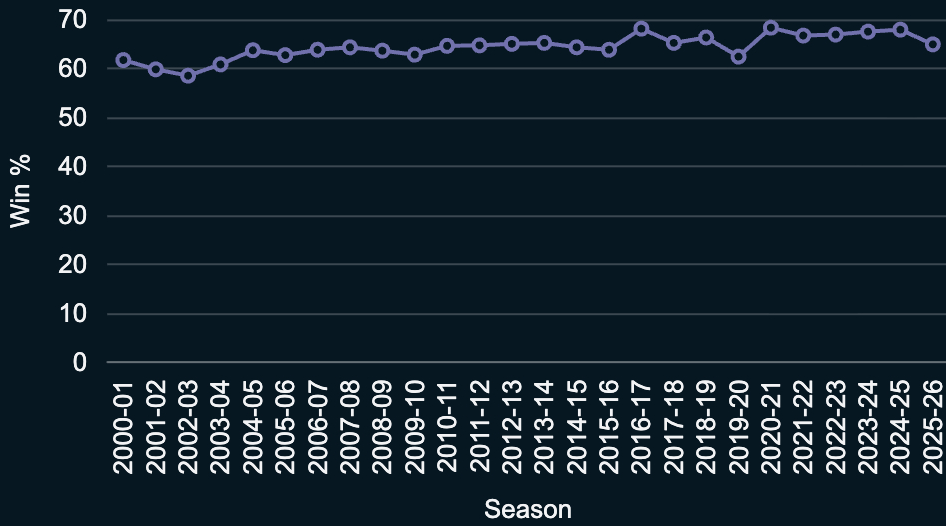
Win the three-point battle, win the game. How often the team that makes more threes in a game wins it. About 62% in 2000-01, and 65–68% in most seasons since 2016-17. As threes became a bigger share of scoring, winning that matchup became more decisive.

Correlation with win %: three-point volume vs accuracy

● corr_3pa_volume_vs_win_pct ● corr_3p_accuracy_vs_win_pct



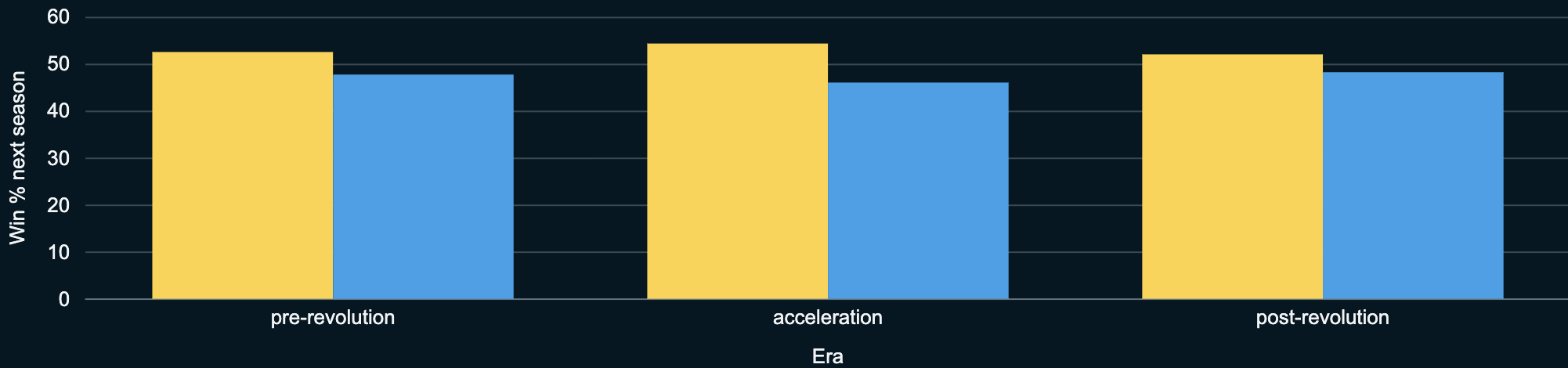
Win % for the team that makes more threes



Did moving early pay off? Teams above the league-average three-point share won 52–54% of their games the following season. Teams below it won 46–48%. The gap was widest during the acceleration era (54.3% vs 46.0%), when being ahead of the trend was still rare. Two seasons out the gap was smaller but still there (51.5–53.2% vs 47.0–48.6%); the chart shows the following season only.

Did moving early pay off? Win % the next season

● above league avg ● below league avg



The best records since 2015-16. The 73-9 Warriors of 2015-16 led the league in three-point attempts. But 67-15 San Antonio (2015-16) and 64-18 Phoenix (2021-22) ranked 26th. Great teams shoot threes well; they don't all shoot the most.

Best records since 2015-16 and their three-point profile							
season	team_name	wins	losses	win_pct	fg3a_per_game	three_point_pct	league_rank_3pa
2015-16	Golden State Warriors	73	9	0.89	31.61	41.6	1
2024-25	Oklahoma City Thunder	68	14	0.83	38.83	37.4	10
2015-16	San Antonio Spurs	67	15	0.82	18.51	37.5	26
2016-17	Golden State Warriors	67	15	0.82	31.24	38.3	5
2017-18	Houston Rockets	65	17	0.79	42.32	36.2	1
2021-22	Phoenix Suns	64	18	0.78	31.9	36.4	26
2023-24	Boston Celtics	64	18	0.78	42.46	38.8	1
2024-25	Cleveland Cavaliers	64	18	0.78	41.48	38.3	4
2025-26	Oklahoma City Thunder	64	18	0.78	37.94	36.5	13
2019-20	Milwaukee Bucks	56	17	0.77	38.9	35.5	4
2025-26	San Antonio Spurs	62	20	0.76	37.9	35.9	14
2016-17	San Antonio Spurs	61	21	0.74	23.5	39.1	25
2024-25	Boston Celtics	61	21	0.74	48.23	36.8	1
2019-20	Toronto Raptors	53	19	0.74	36.99	37.4	6
2019-20	Los Angeles Lakers	52	19	0.73	31.58	34.9	23
15 rows							

The answer. The NBA moved from an inside game to an outside game in about eight seasons, from 2012-13 to 2019-20. A handful of franchises moved first: Orlando, New York and Houston. Teams ahead of the curve did win more, in the same season and the two after it. But the strongest link to winning is making threes, not just taking them.